



Familiar Nine

Our December 2026 link — what changes for you, in plain English

A proposal for discussion · CEA link · 24 weeks · code F9-24-K31

The short version

Five things to take away if you remember nothing else

35h

**the same
contracted
week**

no extra hours

6

**most days in a
row**

today it can be 9

6 in 24

**full weekends
off**

one in four, not
one in five

9 of 15

**shift times you
already work**

only 6 new ones

30 min

**shorter on
every closing
shift**

45 min on a
Sunday

Same hours, shorter closing shifts, more weekends — and mostly times you already know.

Why the link has to change

Nobody is changing it for the sake of it



A new timetable in December 2026

More trains, at new times — the link has to follow them.



More of us on the link

It grows from 20 weeks to 24, so four more colleagues join it.



New staffing levels

At least 14 on a Saturday and 10 on a Sunday, and more at the open and the close.



The ticket office in fixed pairs

Two early and two late, on the same shifts, every day.

Will I work more?

The first thing everyone asks

	Today	Familiar Nine
Contracted hours a week	35h	35h
Contracted days at work a week	4.2	4.17
Contracted days at work a year	219	217
... after 32 days' annual leave	187	185

No. Exactly the same 35-hour week — and about 2 fewer days at work a year.

Will I be paid less?

Your pay follows your contracted hours

	Today	Familiar Nine
Contracted hours a week	35h	35h
Saturdays a year, at time and a quarter	26	30
Sunday overtime to share — each, a year	21	22

No. The same 35-hour week — plus about four more Saturdays at time and a quarter.

Will my shifts be longer?

Every closing shift gets shorter — the average goes up six minutes

	Today	Familiar Nine
Weekday closer — starts 15:45, not 15:15	8h40	8h10
Saturday closer — starts 15:15, not 14:45	9h10	8h40
Sunday closer — starts 15:15, not 14:30	8h55	8h10
Longest shift anywhere	9h10	9h00
Average shift	8h14	8h20

Every closing shift is 30 to 45 minutes shorter, and nothing runs over 9 hours.

Will I finish late more often?

Yes — about one extra late finish every two or three weeks

	Today	Familiar Nine
Finishing at 23:00 or later — each, a year	39	59
Finishing at 22:00 or later — each, a year	78	91
Starting at 06:20 — each, a year	62	65
Shortest gap between two shifts	12h30	14h20

December needs more people at the close — but every closing shift is shorter.

Will I know the times?

15 shift times in all — 9 of them you already work



You work these today (9)

- 06:20–13:35 · 06:20–14:20
- 06:20–14:50 · 08:30–16:30
- 13:30–21:00 · 14:00–22:30
- 14:30–22:00 · 14:30–23:25
- 15:15–23:55



New times (6)

Weekdays

- 07:00–16:00 — a new early
- 15:45–23:55 — the closer, 30 minutes later than 15:15

Saturday

- 06:20–15:00 — ten minutes on from 06:20–14:50
- 07:30–16:30 — a new early

Sunday

- 07:15–15:30 — the opener, 15 minutes shorter
- 15:15–23:25 — the closer, 45 minutes later than 14:30

Fewer shift times than today (15, not 18) — and most new ones are a small nudge.

Rest and weekends

The biggest improvement over today

	Today	Familiar Nine
Full weekends off	4 in 20	6 in 24
Most days worked in a row	9	6
Rest-day breaks of two days or more	13 of 17	22 of 24
Shortest gap between two shifts	12h30	14h20
Weeks on the same shift time Monday to Friday	7 of 16	14 of 20

A weekend off one week in four, never more than six days on, and more rest.

Earlies, lates and Sundays

The balance you have now stays the same



Half earlies, half lates

The same split as today: every early Monday to Saturday is matched by a late.



Sundays are still overtime

Not part of the contract, same as now — and about the same number of Sundays as today.



Nobody past 23:25 on a Sunday

The Sunday finish stays where it is. That is agreed practice and will remain so.

No shift in the balance of earlies and lates, and no change to how Sundays work.

Booking leave

What 14 days of annual leave buys you, with Sundays off

	Today	Familiar Nine
Days off in a row — best place to book	30	28
Days off in a row — on average	23.4	23.6
Days off in a row — worst place	19	20
Leave needed for four full weeks off	14	15

About the same. A cover week still counts as 4 days of leave, exactly as now.

More staff on the floor

More people on duty with you, all day

	Today	Familiar Nine
On duty on a weekday	11–12	14
On duty on a Saturday / Sunday	10 / 8	14 / 10
Fewest ever on the station floor	2	3
Avoidable tiring patterns in the rota	5	0

Never fewer than three on the floor, and none of the avoidable tiring patterns.

The honest trade-offs

Nothing is free — here is what it costs

Six new shift times to learn

Most are within 10–30 minutes of a time we already work.

Shifts 6 minutes longer on average

That is what buys the two fewer days a year.

Best leave stretch: 28 days, not 30

On average and at worst, about the same as today.

Four cover weeks remain

Now evenly spaced — every sixth week (1, 7, 13, 19).

More late finishes

About 59 a year each at 23:00 or later, against 39 today.

Still a proposal

Your views count before a link is chosen, and who goes on which line is not decided.

At a glance

Today's roster and Familiar Nine, side by side

	Today	Familiar Nine
Contracted hours a week	35h	35h
Contracted days at work a year	219	217
Average shift · longest shift	8h14 · 9h10	8h20 · 9h00
Closing shift: weekday · Saturday · Sunday	8h40 · 9h10 · 8h55	8h10 · 8h40 · 8h10
Full weekends off	4 in 20 (one in five)	6 in 24 (one in four)
Most days worked in a row	9	6
Shortest gap between two shifts	12h30	14h20
Different shift times	18	15 (9 you know)
On duty weekday · Saturday · Sunday	11-12 · 10 · 8	14 · 14 · 10
Avoidable tiring patterns in the rota	5	0

Same hours, fewer days, shorter closers, more weekends — and more colleagues on shift.



What happens next

1. Look at the full proposal sheet — page 3 shows every week of the link
2. Tell us what worries you, even if it is small
3. Your feedback goes to the managers with the proposal

Familiar Nine · F9-24-K31 · every figure worked out from the rota by the Marylebone Roster app